



No Crown Without Blood

A Bannerlord Modlist & Guide

Mount & Blade II: Bannerlord

WS v1.2.7 / BL v1.4.7

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Installation & Setup

This section covers everything you need to set up Bannerlord with BLSE and prepare for any wave. Follow these steps once — they apply to all three waves.

Game Installation

Ensure your Bannerlord installation matches the target version before proceeding.

Warning: All mods in this guide target **WS v1.2.7 / BL v1.4.7 (8 July 2026)**. Mods marked for other versions will not work and may corrupt your saves.

On Steam

- Right-click Mount & Blade II: Bannerlord in your Steam library
- Select **Properties** > **Betas**
- From the dropdown, choose the version matching v1.4.7
- Allow Steam to download the correct version files
- Launch the game once to generate config files, then exit

On GOG / Other Platforms

- Use the platform's version management to select the v1.4.7 build
- If your platform does not support version pinning, you must ensure your installed version matches before proceeding
- Launch once, then exit

Bannerlord Software Extender (BLSE)

BLSE is the mod launcher for this modlist. It manages load order, resolves dependencies, and provides a unified mod management interface.

What BLSE Does

- Sorts mods automatically by dependency and compatibility rules
- Detects version mismatches before you launch
- Provides a clean UI for enabling, disabling, and reordering mods
- Replaces the default Bannerlord launcher entirely

Tip: BLSE is required for all waves, including Wave 0. The default game launcher does not reliably manage mod load order and will cause crashes with multiple mods. Install BLSE even if you only plan to use Wave 0.

Download & Install BLSE

Download BLSE from Nexus Mods

- Download the latest BLSE release
- Extract the archive into your Bannerlord game directory (the folder containing bin\Win64_Shipping_Client\)
- The key files are BannerlordSoftwareExtender.exe and the BLSE folder
- Launch BannerlordSoftwareExtender.exe — this replaces your normal game launch

First Launch with BLSE

- BLSE will scan your game directory and detect installed mods on first launch

- You will see the main mod management screen with a list of detected mods (empty initially for Wave 0)
- The load order panel on the right shows the current order
- BLSE's **Auto-Sort** button resolves dependencies automatically

Tip: Always launch Bannerlord through BLSE, even for Wave 0. Launching through Steam or the default launcher will bypass your mod setup.

BLSE Settings

When you first open BLSE, configure the following:

Setting	Recommended Value
Auto-Sort on Launch	Enabled — ensures load order is always correct
Check for Mod Updates	Enabled — warns you when mods have newer versions
Game Launch Arguments	Leave blank unless you need specific launch flags
Backup Saves	Enabled — creates timestamped save backups before launching

Installing Mods with BLSE

For each mod in a wave's modlist:

1. Download the mod from its Nexus Mods page
2. Extract the mod folder into Modules\ inside your Bannerlord game directory
3. Launch BLSE — the mod will appear in the list
4. Enable the mod by checking its box
5. Use **Auto-Sort** to place it correctly in the load order

Warning: Always check the mod's installation instructions on its Nexus page. Some mods require specific subfolder placement or additional dependencies not listed here.

Wave-Specific Setup

After installing BLSE and your game, follow the **Getting Started** section of your chosen wave. Each wave has its own mod list and recommended game settings.

Choosing Your Wave

- **Wave 0 — The Exile:** You are new to Bannerlord or want a guided first campaign. Minimal mods, complete tutorial.
- **Wave 1 — The Alliance:** You have completed a campaign or are familiar with Bannerlord's basics. Enhanced experience, more mechanics.
- **Wave 2 — The Reckoning:** You are a veteran player seeking a transformed, challenging experience with major overhauls.

Danger: Do not mix mods from different waves. Each wave's mod list is tested as a complete set. Adding Wave 2 mods to a Wave 1 setup will cause conflicts and crashes.

Game Settings

Regardless of your wave, these baseline settings are recommended:

Setting	Value
Difficulty	Freebooter (medium) — adjustable per wave
Autosave Interval	15 minutes — prevents progress loss
Friendly Troops Banner Icons	Enabled — easier battle awareness
Show HUD in Combat	Enabled — shows health, ammo, orders
Graphics API	DirectX 11 — most stable for modded setups
Sound	Default — some mods add audio and rely on default settings

Tip: Graphics settings depend on your hardware. Higher textures and shadows work well with Wave 1+ graphics mods, but start conservatively and increase if your framerate allows.

Troubleshooting

Common issues you may encounter when setting up or playing with this modlist, and how to fix them.

Game Crashes on Startup

The most common issue with modded setups. Work through these checks in order:

BLSE Won't Launch

- Verify BLSE files are in the game root directory (not in a subfolder)
- Run BannerlordSoftwareExtender.exe as Administrator once
- Check that your antivirus has not quarantined BLSE — add an exception for the game folder
- Re-download BLSE from the official page: <https://www.nexusmods.com/mountandblade2-bannerlord/mods/1>

Game Crashes Before Main Menu

- Disable all mods in BLSE and try launching with zero mods
- If the game launches without mods, a mod is the cause. Enable mods one at a time to find the culprit.
- Check that all mod dependencies are installed and enabled (see each wave's mod list for dependency requirements)
- Verify your game version matches WS v1.2.7 / BL v1.4.7

Crash During Loading Screen

- Your save may be corrupted. Try loading an earlier save or a new game.
- Verify load order in BLSE matches the wave's load-order.typ
- Clear the game's shader cache: delete %ProgramData%\Mount and Blade II Bannerlord\Shaders\

Mod-Related Issues

Mod Version Mismatch

BLSE may show a warning that a mod's version does not match your game version. This can happen with mods that have not been updated but still work.

Warning: If a mod shows a version warning but BLSE's Auto-Sort still loads it and the game launches, it is usually safe to use. However, always check the mod's Nexus page for compatibility notes.

Mods Not Detected by BLSE

- Ensure the mod folder is placed directly in Modules\ (e.g., Modules\MyMod\SubModule.xml)
- BLSE reads SubModule.xml in each mod folder. If this file is missing or misplaced, BLSE will not detect the mod.
- Restart BLSE after adding new mods — it scans on launch, not dynamically.

Two Mods Conflict

- Check mod-conflicts.md in this project — known conflicts are documented there
- In BLSE, try adjusting load order manually: the mod loaded **last** takes priority
- Some mods have compatibility patches on their Nexus pages — check the mod's files tab
- If no resolution, choose one mod over the other — running both will cause unpredictable behavior

Save Game Issues

Save Won't Load

- Saves made with mods A, B, C cannot be loaded if mod C is removed. Re-enable removed mods or start a new game.
- Saves from one wave cannot be used with another wave's mod set. Each wave requires a new campaign.
- If a save crashes mid-load, it may be corrupted. Use BLSE's **Backup Saves** feature (enabled in settings) to restore an earlier version.

Save Corrupted

Danger: Never save immediately after a battle or during an autosave. Wait a few seconds for the game to finish post-battle processing. Saving during heavy scripting can corrupt the save file.

- Use the backup save from BLSE if enabled
- If no backup exists, the save is likely unrecoverable. Start a new game with the backup setting enabled.

Performance Issues

Low FPS in Battles

- Reduce battle size in game options (Options > Gameplay > Battle Size)
- Lower shadow quality and particle effects
- Disable any graphics mods temporarily to isolate if a texture mod is the cause
- Verify your GPU drivers are up to date

Stuttering on Campaign Map

- Reduce sound channels in Options > Audio
- This is often CPU-related; close background applications
- Some large mods increase world processing. This is expected in Wave 2 setups.

BLSE-Specific Issues

Auto-Sort Places Mods Incorrectly

BLSE's Auto-Sort uses mod metadata to determine order. If a mod author did not declare dependencies correctly, manual sorting is needed.

- Check the wave's `load-order.typ` for the correct order
- In BLSE, drag the mod to the correct position in the load order panel
- Export your load order for future use: BLSE menu > Export Load Order

“Cannot Resolve Dependencies” Error

- A mod requires another mod that is not installed or enabled
- Check the mod's **Dependencies** field in the wave's mod list
- Install and enable the missing dependency, then re-run Auto-Sort

Getting Help

If none of the above resolves your issue:

- Check the Nexus Mods page of the mod causing issues — the Posts and Bugs tabs often have solutions
- The Bannerlord modding Discord servers are active and helpful
- BLSE's GitHub page has an Issues tracker for launcher-specific problems

Tip: When asking for help online, always mention your game version (WS v1.2.7 / BL v1.4.7), which wave you are playing, and your full mod list. This information is essential for anyone helping you.

Wave 0

The Exile

Introduction

The rain came down in sheets the night your family died. Not the gentle spring rain that nourished your father's fields, but a hard, driving storm that drowned out the screams. You remember the thunder — or was it the heavy boots of your uncle's men on the stone stairs? Memory blurs the worst moments. What remains, sharp as a freshly-honed blade, is the face of your mother's guard, Ser Aldric, dragging you through the servant's passage as the great hall behind you filled with fire.

"Don't look back," he said. "Never look back."

You were fourteen. The youngest child of House Verdan, a minor noble house sworn to the Kingdom of Vlandia. Your father had been a just lord. Your mother, a diplomat who kept the peace between rival houses. Your elder siblings — three of them — had been warriors and scholars, each groomed for a role in the family's future. None of them survived the summit.

Your uncle Evran had called it a peace summit. He came under a banner of truce, with gifts and promises. Your father welcomed his own brother into the great hall with open arms. The poisoning started within the hour. By midnight, your family was dead and Evran's men held the keep. Ser Aldric got you out because he knew a passage your uncle didn't — an old escape tunnel dug during the last war.

You traveled for three weeks without stopping. Aldric sold his sword to buy food. He taught you how to start a fire in the rain, how to tell which villages would give shelter and which would sell you out. He taught you that survival has no honor — only outcomes.

On the border of Battania, in a nameless village that stank of sheep and desperation, Aldric's wounds caught up with him. The fever took three days. You buried him under an old oak, marked the grave with his sword driven into the earth, and walked on alone.

That was two years ago. You are sixteen now, or thereabouts — you stopped counting days after the first winter. You have learned to fight because the alternative is death. You have learned to trade because empty pockets mean empty stomachs. You have learned to lead because a lone wolf is just prey for a larger pack. You are nobody. A nameless face in a world that does not care whether you live or die.

Good. That is your advantage.

You are not here to survive. You are here to learn everything Calradia can teach you — how to fight, how to lead, how to build something from nothing. Because somewhere across these mountains, your uncle Evran still sits on your father's throne. He thinks you died in the fire. He thinks the line of Verdan ended that night.

He is wrong.

You will not go after him yet. You are not ready. You are still weak, still learning, still nobody. But every sword that falls to your blade, every soldier who swears to your banner, every coin you earn through your own cunning — these are the bricks of the foundation you are building. One day, when

you are strong enough, when you have an army at your back and allies who fear your name, you will cross those mountains and remind your uncle that Verdan blood does not die so easily.

But that is another story. This is the story of how you started.

Wave 0 Objectives

Wave 0 is your training ground. Forget revenge for now. Focus on:

1. Learning the fundamentals of combat, trade, and leadership
2. Understanding how the world of Calradia works — its factions, its economy, its rules
3. Building your first warband and earning your first renown
4. Surviving long enough to reach Clan Tier 2
5. Completing a full campaign from obscurity to established mercenary

Tip: There is no rush. Wave 0 is designed for learning — take your time, experiment, make mistakes. You will start over in Wave 1 anyway. Use this wave to understand the game, not to beat it.

What Makes Wave 0 Different

Wave 0 is as close to vanilla Bannerlord as possible. The mod list is restricted to **UI and Quality of Life** improvements only — nothing that changes gameplay mechanics. This means:

1. You experience Bannerlord as the developers intended, but with a smoother interface
2. Every mechanic you learn in Wave 0 carries over to Waves 1 and 2 — mods add depth, not replacements
3. You can compare the vanilla experience to later waves and understand what each mod changes and why

Your Character

For the best roleplaying experience in this wave, create a character that fits the Exile background:

- **Culture:** Vlandia (your homeland) or Battania (where you fled). Both offer bonuses that help a new player.
- **Background:** You were raised in a noble house but have spent two years as a survivor. Choose backgrounds that reflect both privilege and hardship.
- **Starting age:** 16-18 (you were exiled at 14, and a couple of years have passed)
- **Starting skills:** Prioritize One-Handed (Aldric's training), Athletics (you walked across half a continent), and Trade (you learned to survive on nothing)

Tip: Character creation is covered in detail in the **How to Play** section. For now, just remember: you are not a hero yet. You are a refugee with a grudge and a long road ahead. Build accordingly.